THE RESTLESS FOUNDER / FREE GUIDE

The Buy-Back Map

A five page guide to getting your hours back: what to hand to AI, what to hire, what to protect and what to keep human.

You do not get free by doing more.

Find your $20 an hour work.

Every low value task you remove makes room for high value work. The loop only starts once you can see which is which.

HOUSE	**Cleaning, laundry, errands.** Buys back focus, energy and free evenings. AI help: a weekly plan and a shopping list.
ADMIN	**Inbox, scheduling, follow-ups.** Most people are running a part-time admin job without noticing. AI help: drafts, summaries, reminders.
BODY	**Training and food.** Your work needs energy too. A booked session beats a good intention.
MONEY	**Tax and bookkeeping.** Hand the filing to a qualified professional and keep the decisions. AI help: tidy notes before the meeting.
FOCUS	**A chief of staff.** Someone who multiplies you and keeps things moving while you are elsewhere. AI is the first version of this.

1 THE WEEK AUDIT

```
Here is everything I did last week, roughly: (paste a messy list).
Sort each item into four groups: Keep (only I can do it), AI (a draft
or a first pass will do), Hire (a person should do it) and Drop (it
does not matter). For each AI and Hire item, name the first step to
hand it off.
```

Start with one task, not five. Not financial advice: price every hire against your own numbers.

Busy and free are not the same thing.

A full day can feel like progress and still leave nothing built. Motion is being occupied. Progress is something that exists at the end of the week that did not before.

Motion

Replying. Attending. Tidying. Fixing what was fixed last week. Looking productive.

Progress

A page published. An offer made. A system finished. One thing that moves the main thing forward.

1 **Find your best hours.** Note when you think most clearly. For many people it is the first two or three hours of the day.

2 **Protect a sliver.** One block, on the calendar, with your name on it. It goes to what you are building, not to other people's requests.

3 **Build in the margins.** Keep the edges of the day for what you are building, and let AI take the admin and repeat work around it.

2 MOTION OR PROGRESS

```
Here is my last five working days: (paste). Mark every item as motion
or progress. Then tell me which single block of my best energy I
should protect this week, and which three motion tasks could be
shortened, batched or handed to AI.
```

One protected hour a day is the start.

A CEO has three jobs.

Build the team, keep the business alive, and set the direction. Everything else can be handed off, or it is a sign one of the three is unclear.

1 TEAM	**Get the right people, then get out of their way.** If you are still doing everything, either the wrong person has the role or they have not been set up to do the job. Check which, in writing.
2 RUNWAY	**Do not run out of money.** Protect the house: one simple system to make it, grow it and keep it. If you are anxious about revenue every week, the system needs work, not more worry.
3 DIRECTION	**Set the coordinates.** Your team needs to know where they are going and how decisions get made. If people have to ask you about every small thing, the direction is not yet clear enough to leave your head.

3 THE FRIDAY CHECK

```
Here is what I did this week: (paste). Score me from 1 to 5 on three
jobs: team (could others act without me), runway (could I see my
numbers in two minutes), direction (could someone state where we are
going). Name the weakest, and give me one fifteen minute action for
next week.
```

4 THE DECISION RULE

```
Write a one page decision guide for my team: what they decide alone,
what they tell me after, and what they must ask me first. Use the
last month of questions they brought me: (paste).
```

Sell by listening. AI does the prep.

Selling is one job you cannot fully hand away. A five letter formula keeps it human, and AI handles the preparation around it.

T TUNE IN	Aim to listen about twice as much as you talk. Ask clarifying questions and let the silence work.
R REFLECT	Mirror back their frustration in their own words. People buy from the person who understands them best.
U UNCOVER	Ask what they have already tried, and why it did not work.
S SHARE	Tell a short, true story about someone like them. Use specifics, not pitches.
T TRADE	Frame your offer as the logical missing piece, and sell the outcome they actually want.

5 THE CALL PREP

```
I am speaking with someone who needs (the problem). Here is what I
know about them: (paste public information only). Write five
questions for Tune in and Uncover, two sentences I could use to
reflect their frustration back, and one honest story I could share.
Do not invent facts or results.
```

Keep customer details out of AI tools: use public information, first names or initials only. Share only true stories.

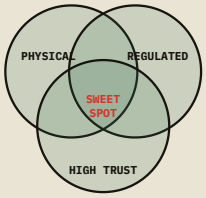
Keep what the bots cannot do.

The same map works for a business or a task. The more of these three circles it sits in, the harder it is for AI to replace.

1 **Physical.** It needs hands, a vehicle, a site or equipment. Think warehouses, repair, logistics yards.

2 **Regulated.** It needs permits, licences or accountable people, as in waste collection, fire safety or environmental cleanup.

3 **High trust.** A person has to stand behind it: a large contract, security for valuable assets, a hard conversation.



Where all three overlap is the sweet spot: work that is hard for a bot to take, and easy to build a steady business around.

6 THE CIRCLE SCORE

```
Here is a task, role or business idea: (describe it). Score it from 0
to 3 on physical, regulated and high trust, with one sentence of
reasoning each. Then list what AI can safely do inside it, and what
must stay with a person.
```

Your map, in one line

Hand the low value work to AI or a person. Protect your best hours. Run the three jobs. Sell by listening. Keep your hands on what only a human can do.

A working guide to adapt, not financial, legal or business advice. Results depend on you, your market and many things outside your control.

Do less of what does not make you free.